



SERVICES PROVIDED

Architect

PROJECT TYPE

Office

LOCATION

Kigali, Rwanda

STATUS

Completed in 2020

The recent winner of the 2020 Outstanding Property Awards London under the Architectural Design, High Rise Commercial building category.

The 9-story building initially started off on an entirely different brief. The client required a series of shops along a strip on an entirely different site but later came in with an alternative site that required a high-rise block constructed in place of the shops. PLANNING undertook the conceptualization of the building that required 4–5 idea explorations until the client was happy with what is now the final design. Inspired by the traditional brick technology common in Rwanda, it was decided early on that it would be the main material utilized on the building rather than the common glazing that is very cognizant of many office blocks. A lot of experimentation and research during the pre-contract stage was done by the PLANNING Team in partnership with the contractor to ensure brick façade would work on such a large scale. The curved corners of the building are to show the versatility of the brick.

The building has been designed & oriented to optimize the site as well as seamlessly integrating with the existing context. Internally, two blocks are joined by the core and service spaces with a large atrium at its heart. The atrium diffuses quality natural light and ventilation to the floors whose balcony accesses give maximum subdivision pliancy - useful in a city where businesses wanting to rent may not be big enough to fill a floor. The services and the core of the building are oriented along the East-West façade while the livable spaces are located along the North-South façade shielding occupants from the harsh tropic sun. For building maintenance, walkways have been provided between the glazed façade and the brick external skin, this also acts as break out spaces for occupants. Public spaces have also been provided on the roof of the building as well as the ground floor. The roof serves as massive solar energy harvester and rainwater catchment area.